ONLINE ARTIST TALK · FPT UNIVERSITY · WEDNESDAY 21 OCTOBER

From Here

To Anywhere

A creative practice in AR, interactive media and collaboration

Bin Youn

Multimedia Artist · Educator · Researcher
Associate Lecturer, Digital Media, RMIT Vietnam





INTRODUCTION

Bin Youn

윤빈 · 尹彬

Korean

interdisciplinary artist

AR / XR

rider

multimedia

alienation

displacement

educator

installation

researcher

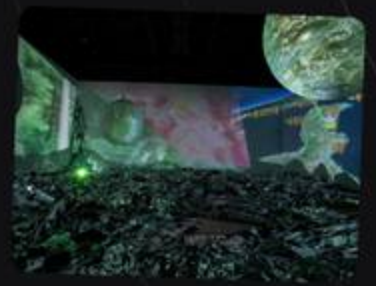
light

five elements

islands

photographer

poet





A SHORT HISTORY · 1 · SEOUL AND PARIS, 2009–2013

In Paris, I fell into photography.

In college I was already into art and creative practice, but no one around me supported it.

2009

Daewon Foreign Language high school in Seoul: French major

2010

TA, SKKU International Summer Semester: Creative Mind in Life; City Design and Renewal

2011 · Paris

Exchange semester. I already loved art, design and photos. Here, I fell into photography.

2011–2013

Back in Seoul, learning photography outside my school program

2013

Graduated from Sungkyunkwan University: Consumer & Family Sciences and Business

A SHORT HISTORY · 2 · TOWARD CALIFORNIA, 2017–2020

A dream, a break, and then the road.



A SHORT HISTORY · MOVING

MOVEMENT MOMENT

Take “ve” out of movement, and you get a moment.

A SHORT HISTORY · THE RIDE · KOREA, FROM 2020

I learned to ride during COVID.

"Passing through all the waves from mountains, oceans, rocks, and wind... All my planes were open and intermingled."



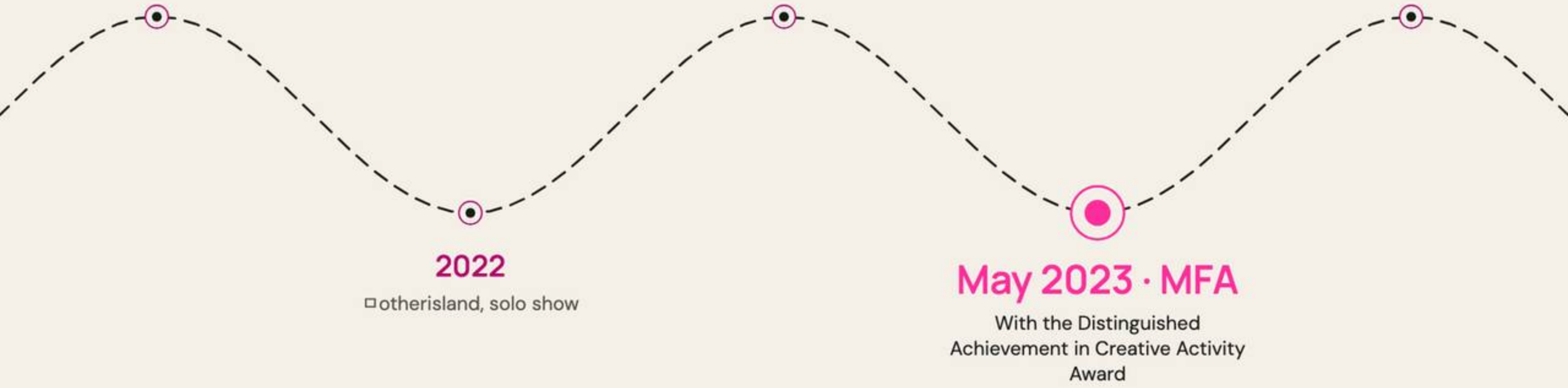






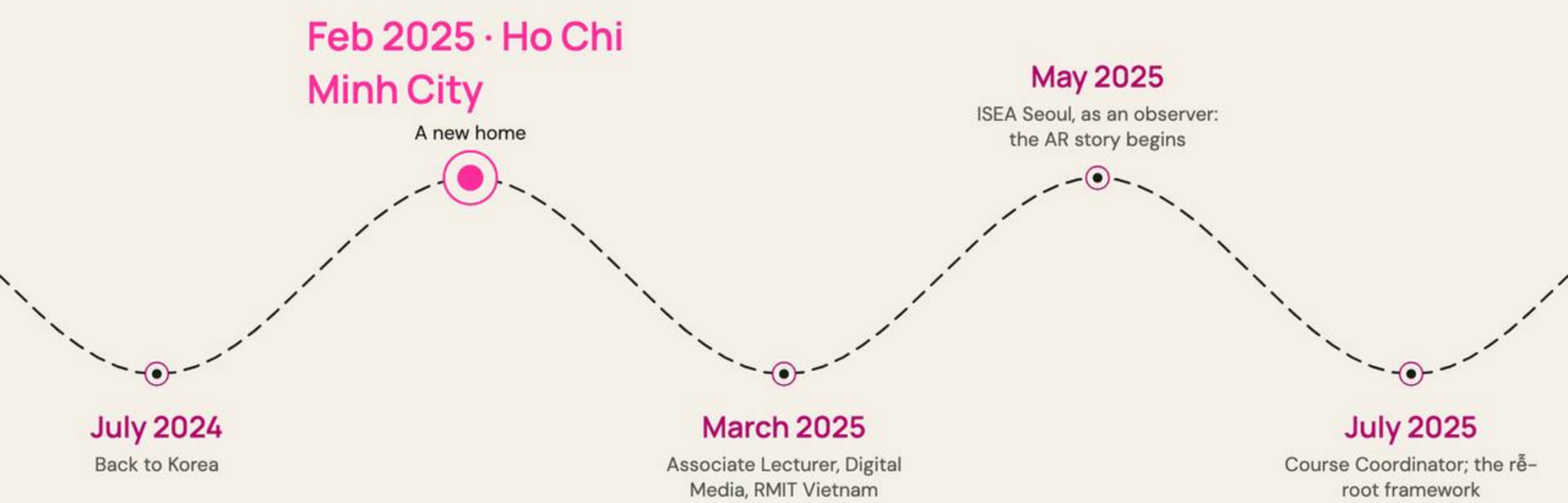
A SHORT HISTORY · 3 · LONG BEACH, 2021–2024

Back to California. The road became installations.



A SHORT HISTORY · 4 · HO CHI MINH CITY, 2024 – NOW

A new city, a classroom, and a new medium.



TODAY

How the session runs

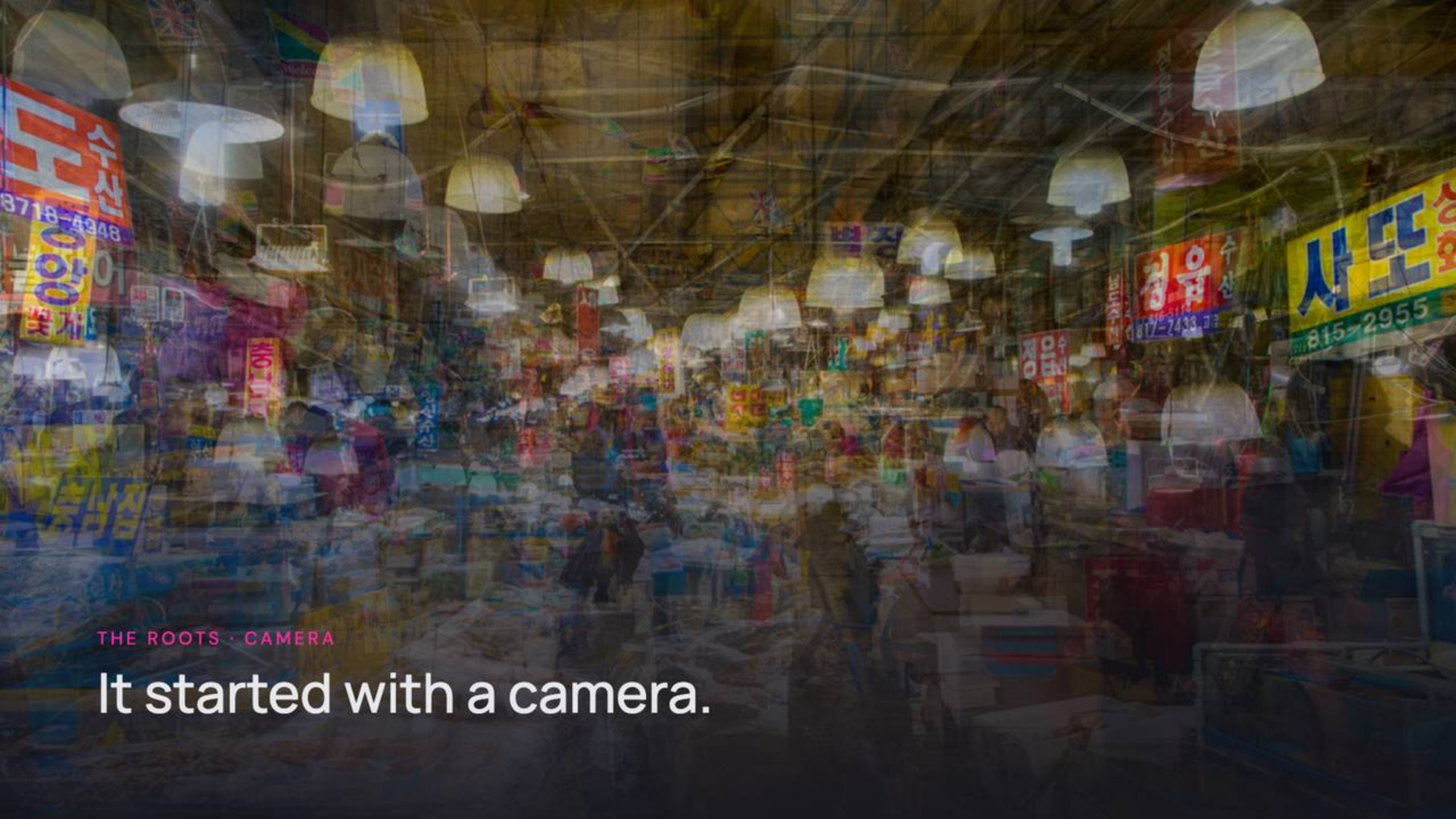
01	Introduction	5 min
02	The AR story	35–40 min
03	Going international: SIGGRAPH and ISEA	15–20 min
04	Student projects: M-NODE	15–20 min
05	Q&A and discussion	10–15 min
06	The upcoming workshop	5 min

PART 02 · 35–40 MIN

The AR story

From observer to presenter in one year.





THE ROOTS · CAMERA

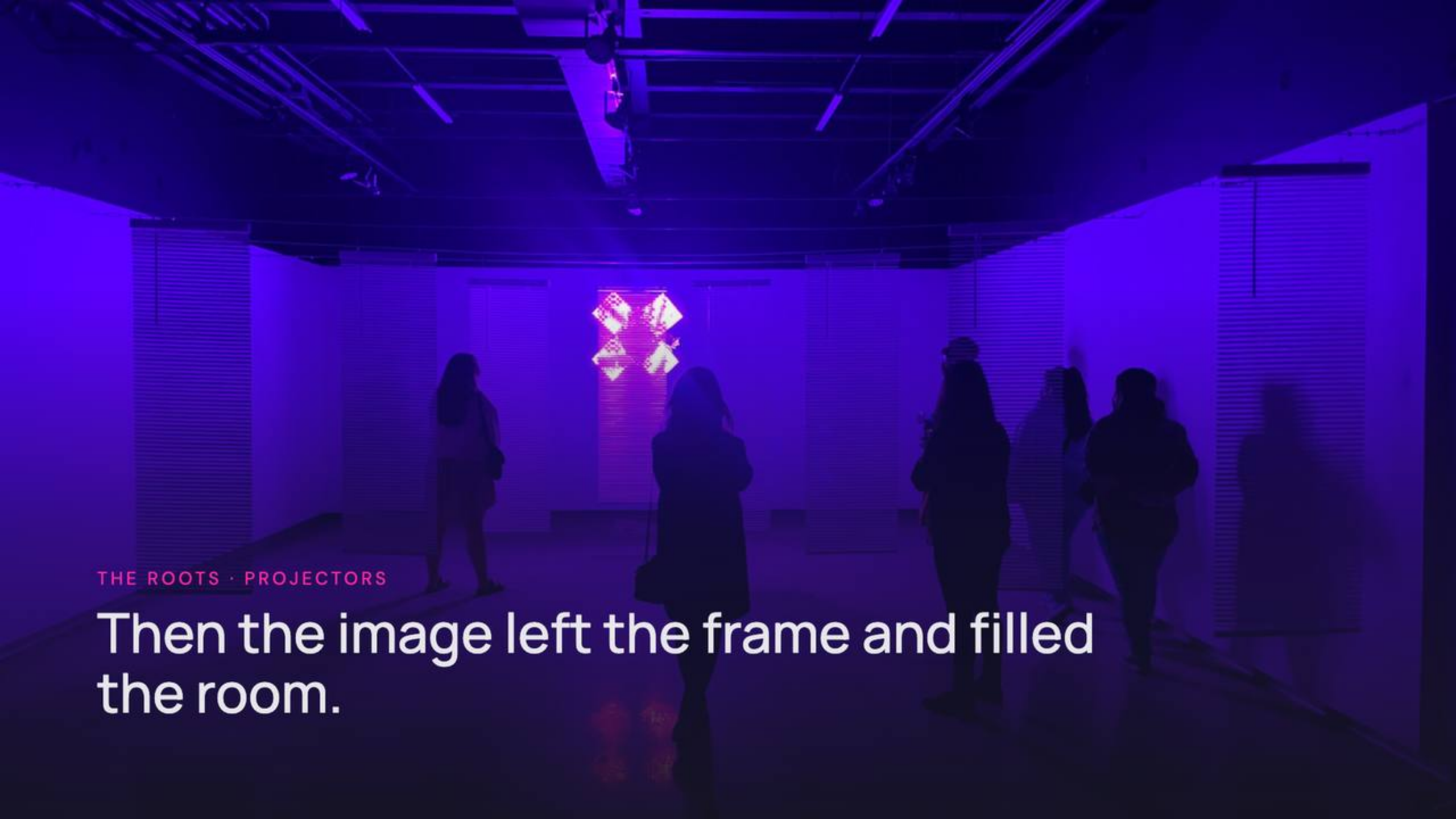
It started with a camera.

THE ROOTS · SCANNER

Then a scanner: a camera without a lens.

Scanography of flowers and found matter





THE ROOTS · PROJECTORS

Then the image left the frame and filled the room.



THE ROOTS · INSTALLATION · 2022

otherisland

"Visitors navigate their own landscapes stepping on shiny foreign flimsy ground."

Medium 5-channel video, projectors, balloons, thermal blankets

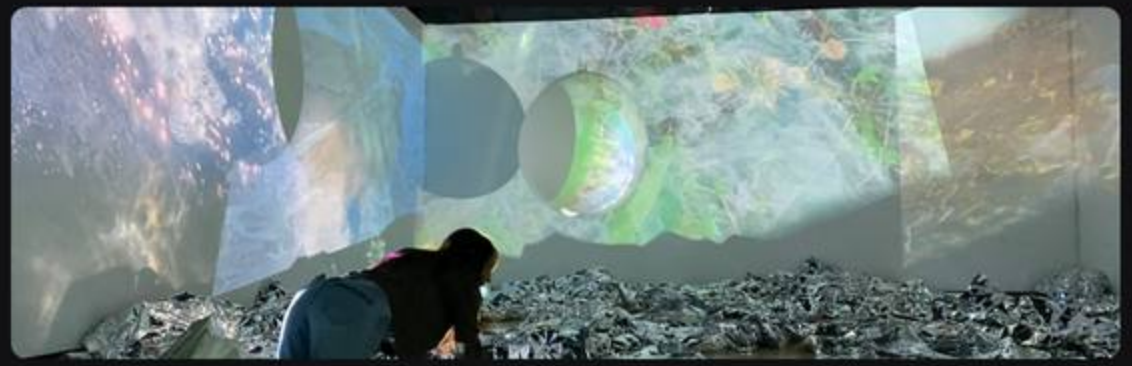
Solo show Gatov Gallery East, CSULB, Long Beach

Travelled to iNVENTX 2025, MMU Malaysia

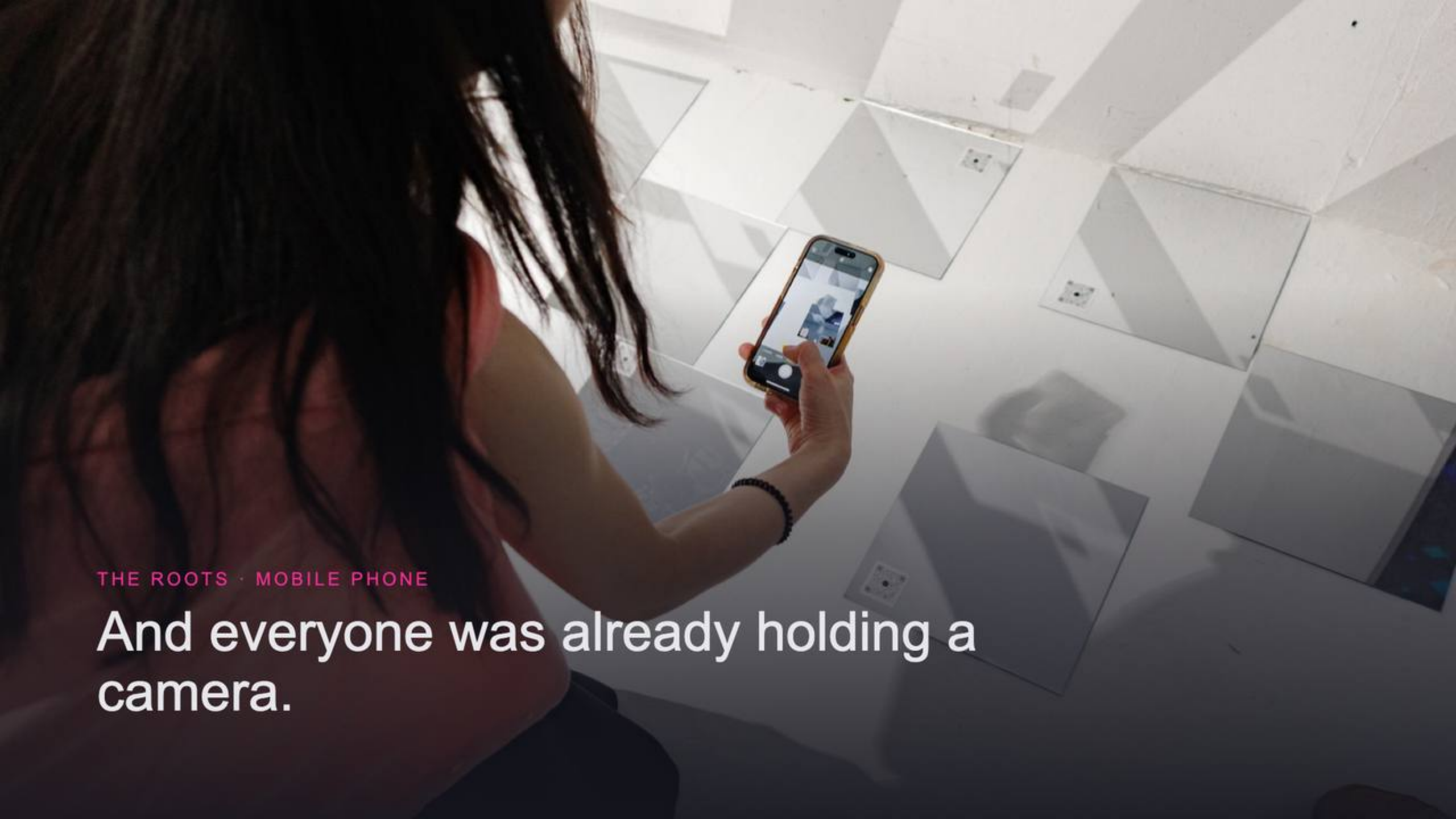
OTHERISLAND · LONG BEACH

Visitors’ bodies and shadows became part of the work.









THE ROOTS · MOBILE PHONE

And everyone was already holding a camera.

CHAPTER 1 · HOW IT STARTED

ISEA Seoul, May 2025. I went as an observer.

A colleague told me about it.
I paid my own way, to look, listen and try things.

CHAPTER 1 · THE GOAL

Next year, I’ll be part of it.

I left Seoul with one goal.
Everything after this slide came from it.

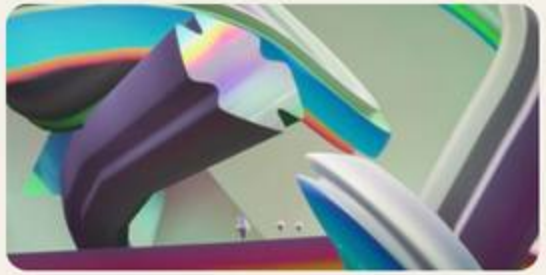
CHAPTER 1 · HOW IT STARTED

Meeting Linda Loh at a workshop

An artist from Naarm / Melbourne working with light, projection, VR and 3D, and already showing her sculptures in AR.

How she did it	She had developed her own app to run her AR work
Where I was	I asked questions, but I still didn't know how to start







Linda Loh · AR, The Corridor Project, 2025 · Agog, VR (Beyond Agog, 2021) · lindaloh.com

CHAPTER 1 · HOW IT STARTED

Trying different ways in

Option 1

8th Wall

The popular WebAR platform at the time

Option 2

AR apps

[The apps you tried, and why they didn't fit]

Option 3

Build an app

Linda's route, and too much for one artist to start with

What worked

A-Frame + vibe coding

Web-based, free, and something I could build myself

CHAPTER 1 · THE BREAKTHROUGH

A-Frame + vibe coding

A-Frame

Write 3D and AR scenes like a web page. Runs in the phone's browser: no app to install.

```
<a-scene>
<a-entity gltf-model="#gelora"></a-entity>
</a-scene>
```

Vibe coding

Describe what you want in plain words, let AI write the code, test it on your phone, then repeat.

You don't need to be a developer. You need to know what the work should feel like.

CHAPTER 1 · FROM MY GITHUB

One month after ISEA, my first AR repo.

13 Jun 2025	geloracompass · gelora
Nov 2025	gelora_network · gelora_mycelium · gelora-bagua
Dec 2025	sacredtree
May 2026	uncanny-garden
Oct 2026	glitch-mori · 46 public repos

LIVE POLL · OPEN ANSWER

Think of a place you've left behind. What would you bring back there in AR?

One place, one thing. Mine was a fallen flower, brought back to the ground it fell on.

CHAPTER 2 · THE FIRST GELORA

A fallen flower. Scanned. Preserved. Reanimated.

Gelora: gel + flora



CHAPTER 2 · IN AR

“Gelora awakens. Feel around and touch.”

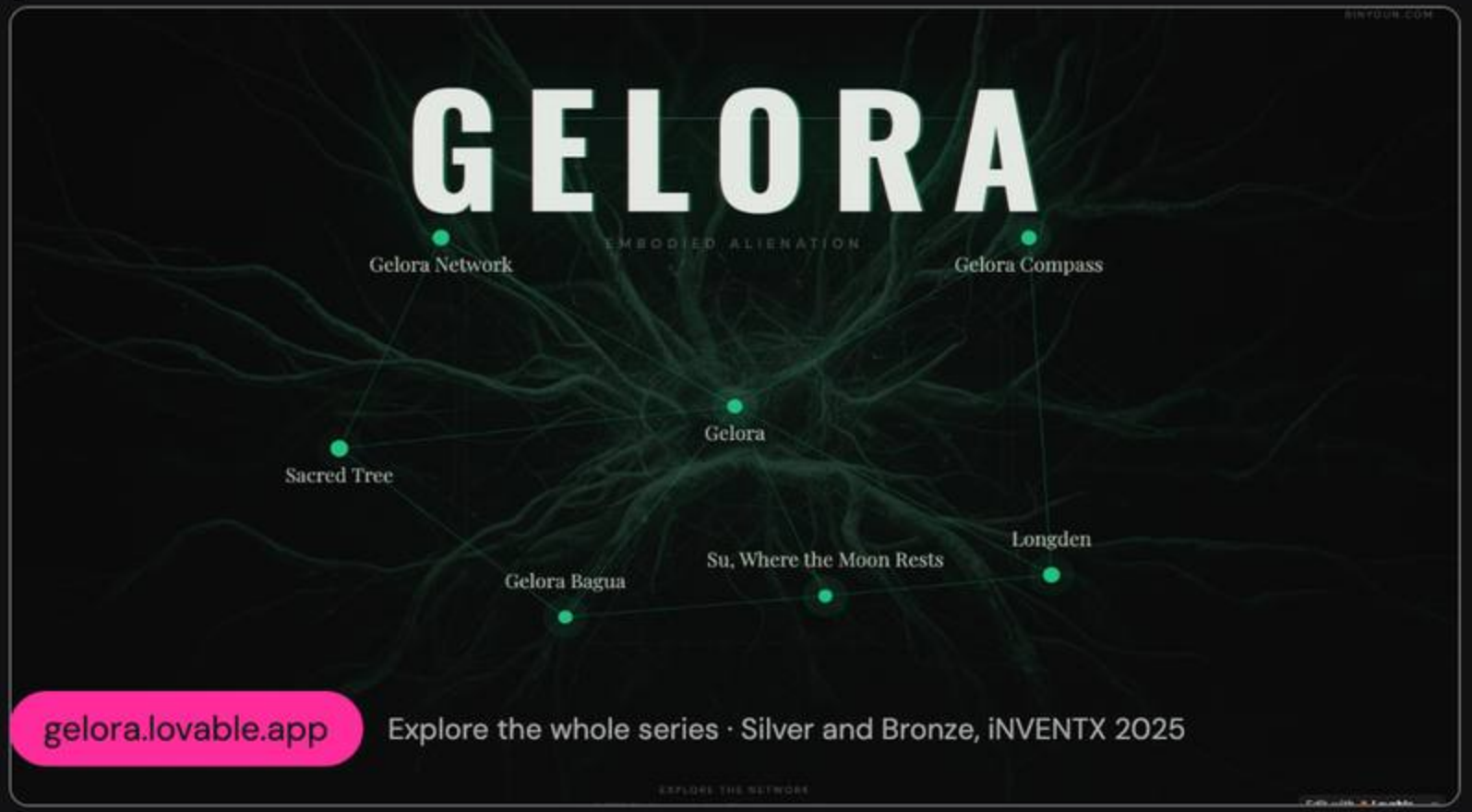
Runs in the phone’s browser. No app. Later versions added a bagua compass: the eight directions around you.

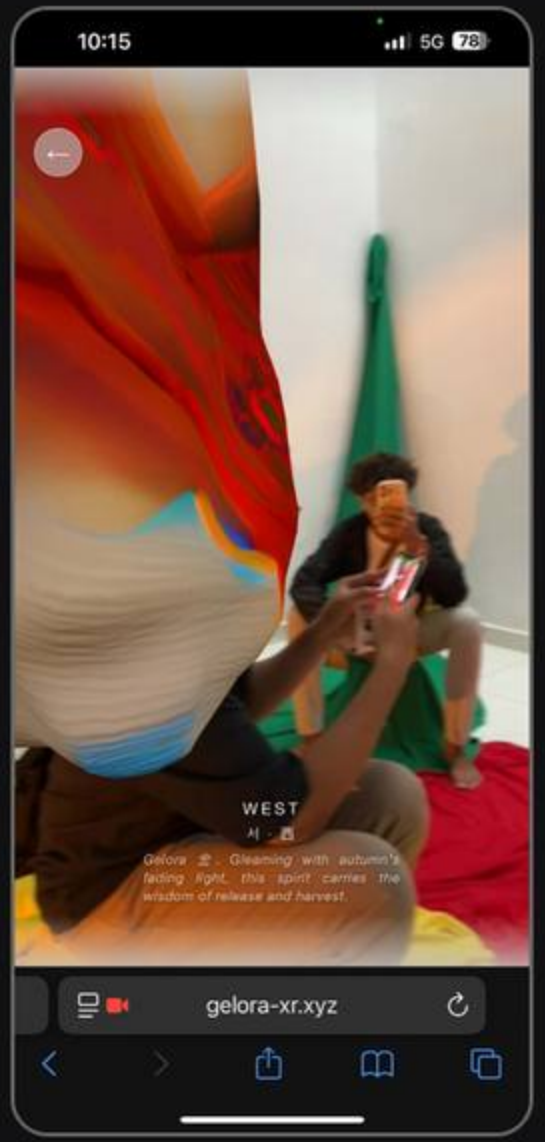




CHAPTER 2 · MY FIRST AR WORK · 2025 – NOW

Gelora: one family of creatures, many places.





Gelora West, in AR · gelora-xr.xyz

GELORA · AUDIENCES · 2025

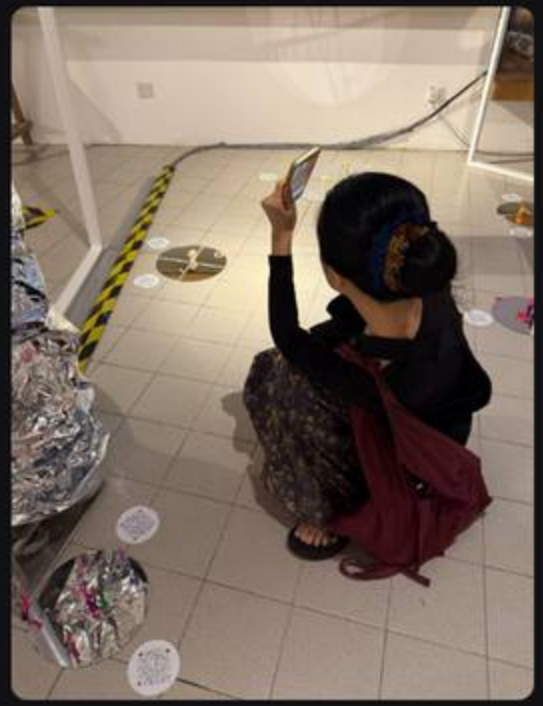
The phone became the way into the work.



Mirror Ver.
Beyond 1&0, HCMC



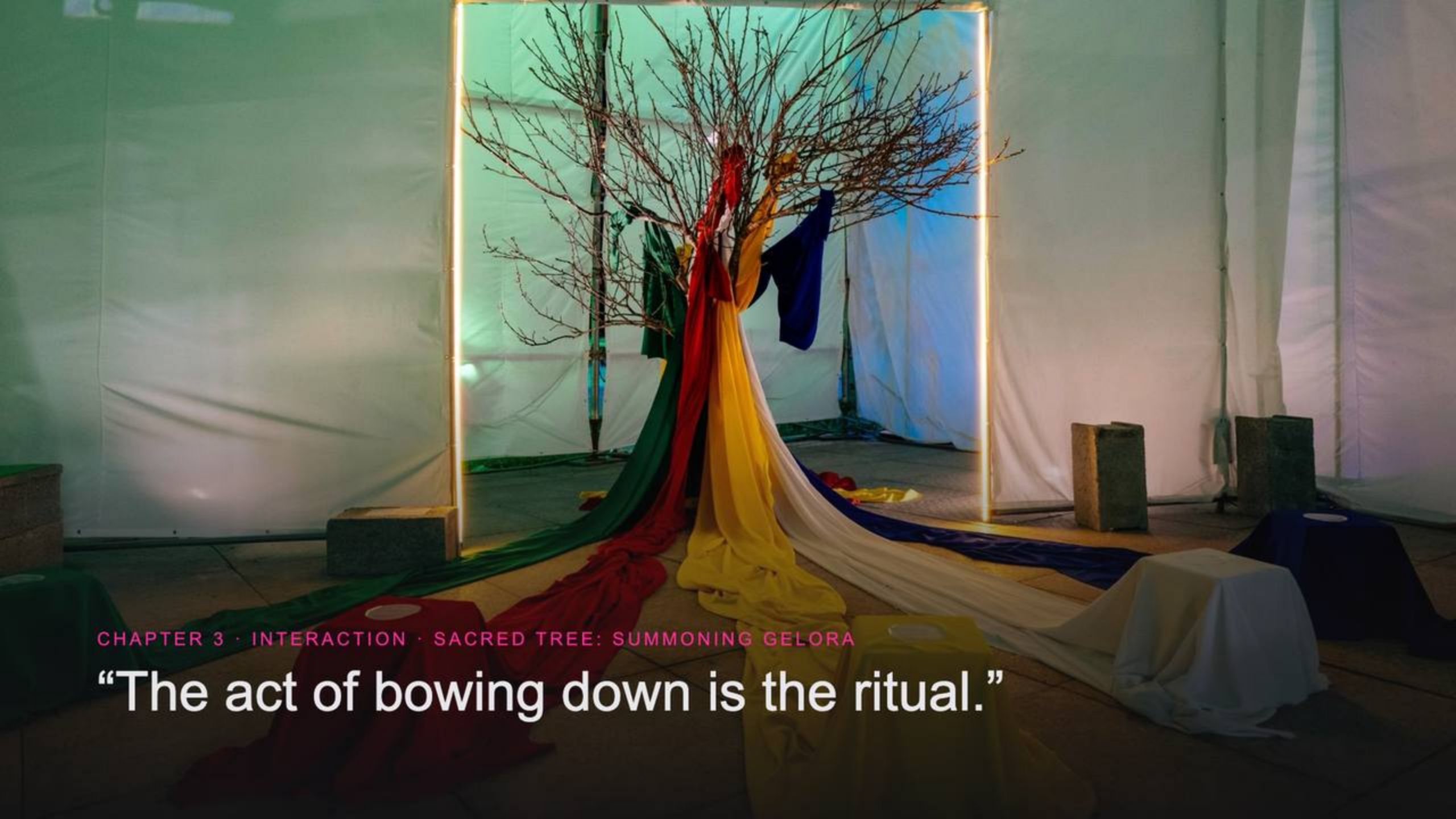
Corner Ver.
iNVENTX, MMU Malaysia



Mycelium Network
Evolving Matter, MMU



Gelora within Bagua
Evolving Matter, MMU



CHAPTER 3 · INTERACTION · SACRED TREE: SUMMONING GELORA

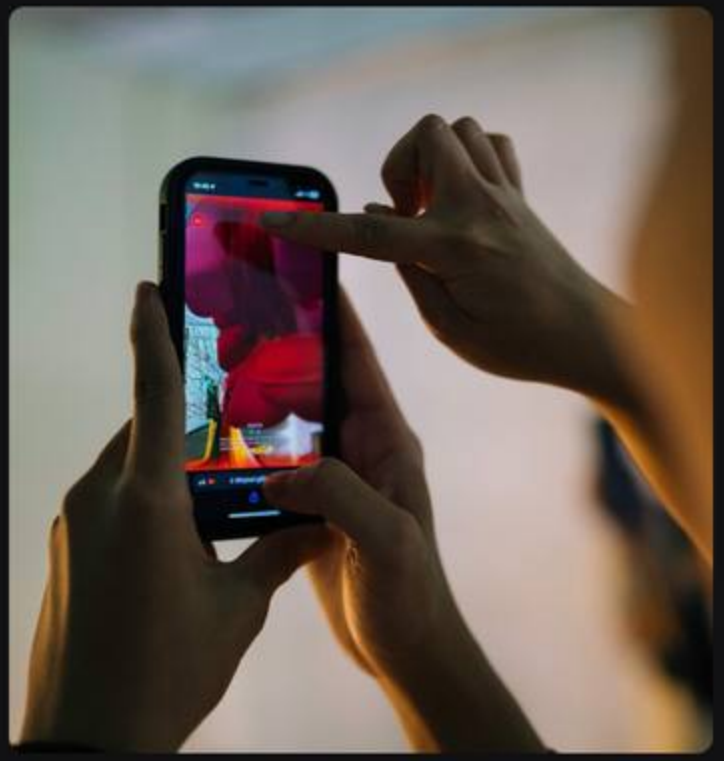
“The act of bowing down is the ritual.”

SACRED TREE: SUMMONING GELORA · THE RITUAL

Bow down. Tap the portal. Summon together.



01 Bow down to the ground



02 Tap the portal, touch Gelora



03 Summon Gelora, together



The five portals around the tree · HOZO City Tết Fest, 2025

HOW IT WORKS · 2026 SOUND EDITION

Five portals, one tree.

Five NFC portals in the five directions: wood east, fire south, metal west, water north, earth centre

WebXR with A-Frame; a pentatonic soundscape in Tone.js that follows your movement

3 m × 3 m space · headphones on · with Patrick Hartono

SACRED TREE · HOW IT GREW

From a festival to a research artefact.

2025	HOZO City Tết Fest, Ho Chi Minh City: Web AR, no sound
2026	Summoning Gelora, the sound edition with Patrick Hartono
May 2026	Tell.Me 2026, Macau: artefact and paper

Try it now: gelora-xr.xyz



UNCANNY GARDEN

YOUR HAND GESTURES
BLOOM FIVE ELEMENTAL
FLOWERGIRLS.

CHAPTER 4 · COLLABORATION · 2026

Randi Matushevitz · Bin Youn · Gustavo Guzmán
LACDA and SIGGRAPH DAC, Los Angeles

Uncanny Garden
– Randi Matushevitz – Bin Youn – Gustavo Guzman



Uncanny Garden is a collaborative augmented reality and sound work inspired by Randi Matushevitz's Flowergirl (2026) and Limelight (2026). Participants summon five Flowergirls through hand gestures rooted in elemental cosmology, each seeding, blooming, becoming. A mediated ritual exploring fertility, transformation, and the nature of self in a surrealist botanical world.

https://dac.siggraph.org/artwork/uncanny-garden/



UNCANNY GARDEN · THE TEAM

Three artists, three countries, one Zoom room.



Randi Matushevitz
Visual · Techspressionist
Visual artist · Los Angeles, USA



Bin Youn
AR & interaction
RMIT Vietnam · Ho Chi Minh City



Gustavo Guzmán
Sound
Composer, artist, researcher · Valparaíso, Chile

Uncanny Garden, 2026 · LACDA and SIGGRAPH DAC, Los Angeles

UNCANNY GARDEN · THE STARTING POINT

It began with Randi's Flowergirl.



Flowergirl, 2026 · Randi Matushevitz



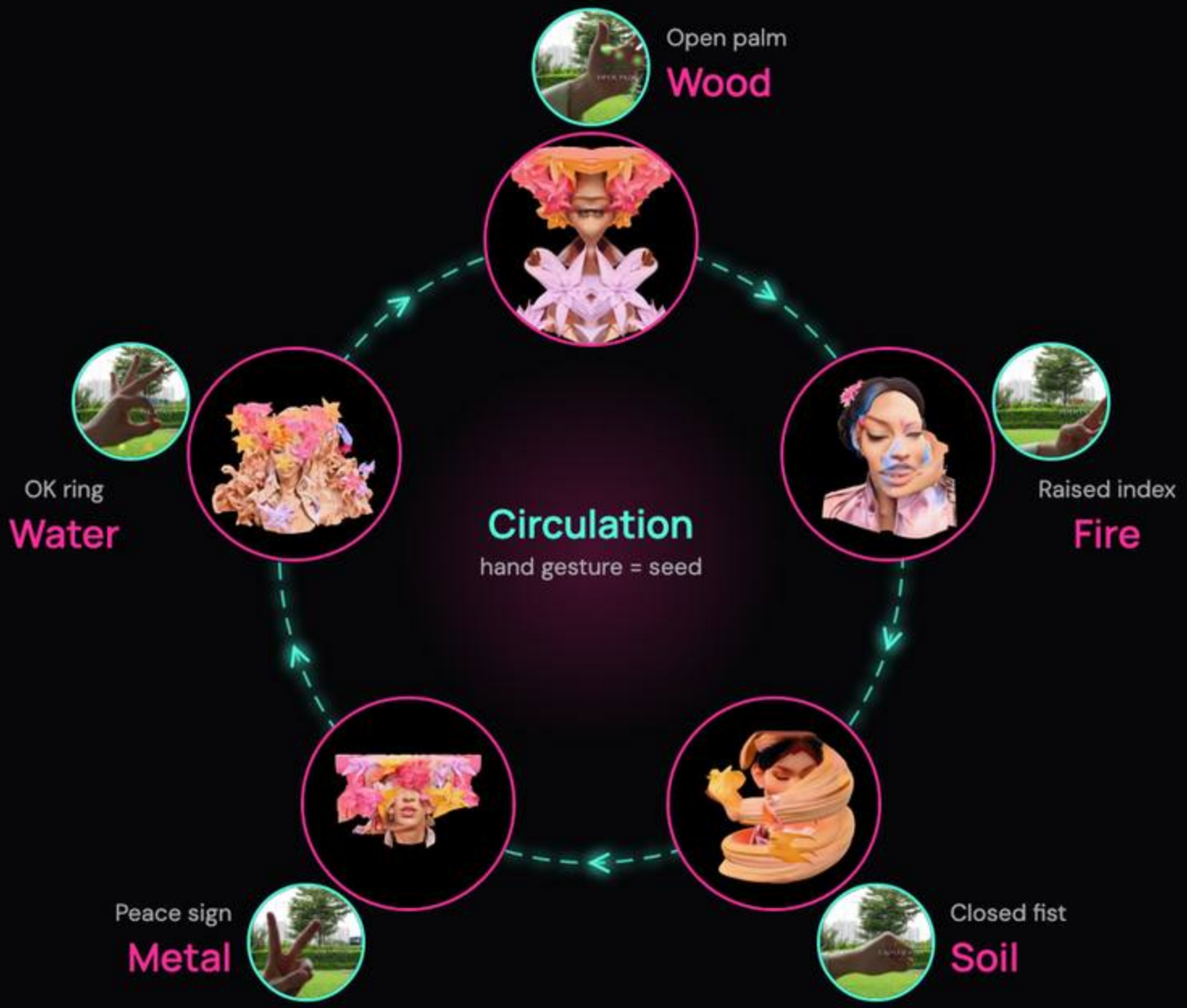
Limelight, 2026 · Randi Matushevitz

UNCANNY GARDEN · AR & INTERACTION

Five Flowergirls. Five gestures.

Hold a gesture for 1.5 seconds. Your hand is the seed, and a Flowergirl blooms. When all five grow, they circle around you.

Scan to try it:
uncanny.live



UNCANNY GARDEN · HOW IT GROWS

One gesture, one life cycle.

Every Flowergirl is planted, grows, fades and rests. Then you can wake it again.



NOW · GLITCH MORI · 2026

Offer your open palm, and a vanished flower grows.

Sow	Hold out an open palm; a ring fills while you stay still
Grow	The flower roots in your hand and glitches into life
Touch	Close your hand and it withers; a fingertip near a petal makes it glitch
Pour	Tilt your palm to pour the petals away; its name appears, and the next flower begins

binyoun.github.io/glitch-mori



Five extinct or endangered flowers, each wearing my scan of a Ho Chi Minh City sidewalk flower · hand tracking in the browser; camera frames never leave your phone

A QUESTION FOR YOU

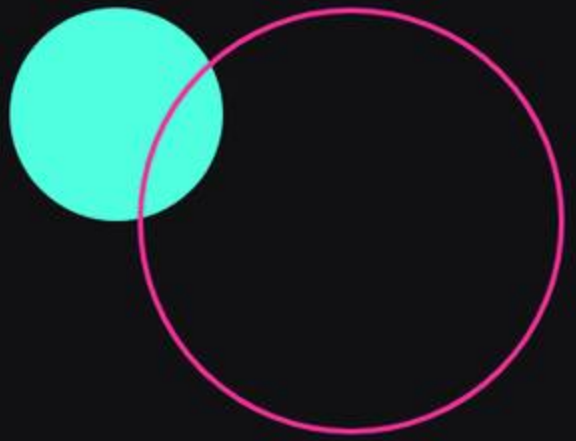
A camera, a scanner, a phone, my two hands. Simple tools took me from here to anywhere.

What will you make with what you already have?

PART 03 · 15–20 MIN

Going international

Ars Electronica, SIGGRAPH, ISEA, and how to take the first step.



GOING INTERNATIONAL · FIRST, THE MAP

The big three of electronic art

SINCE 1979

Ars Electronica

Linz, Austria

A festival, the Prix Ars Electronica, and a museum of the future

SINCE 1974

SIGGRAPH

ACM · North America

Computer graphics and interaction, with an Art Gallery. Plus SIGGRAPH Asia

SINCE 1988

ISEA

a new city each year

The symposium where artists, scientists and researchers meet

GOING INTERNATIONAL

From observer to presenter







May 2025
ISEA Seoul, as an observer

Sep 2025
Gelora at Beyond 1&0, HCMC

Nov 2025
First AR work at iNVENTX, MMU

Jan 2026
Co-moderating SIGGRAPH DAC Sparks

Jul 2026
Uncanny Garden at SIGGRAPH DAC and LACDA

Sep 2026
DAC Sparks panel

Nov 2026
ISEA Dubai workshop, awaiting approval

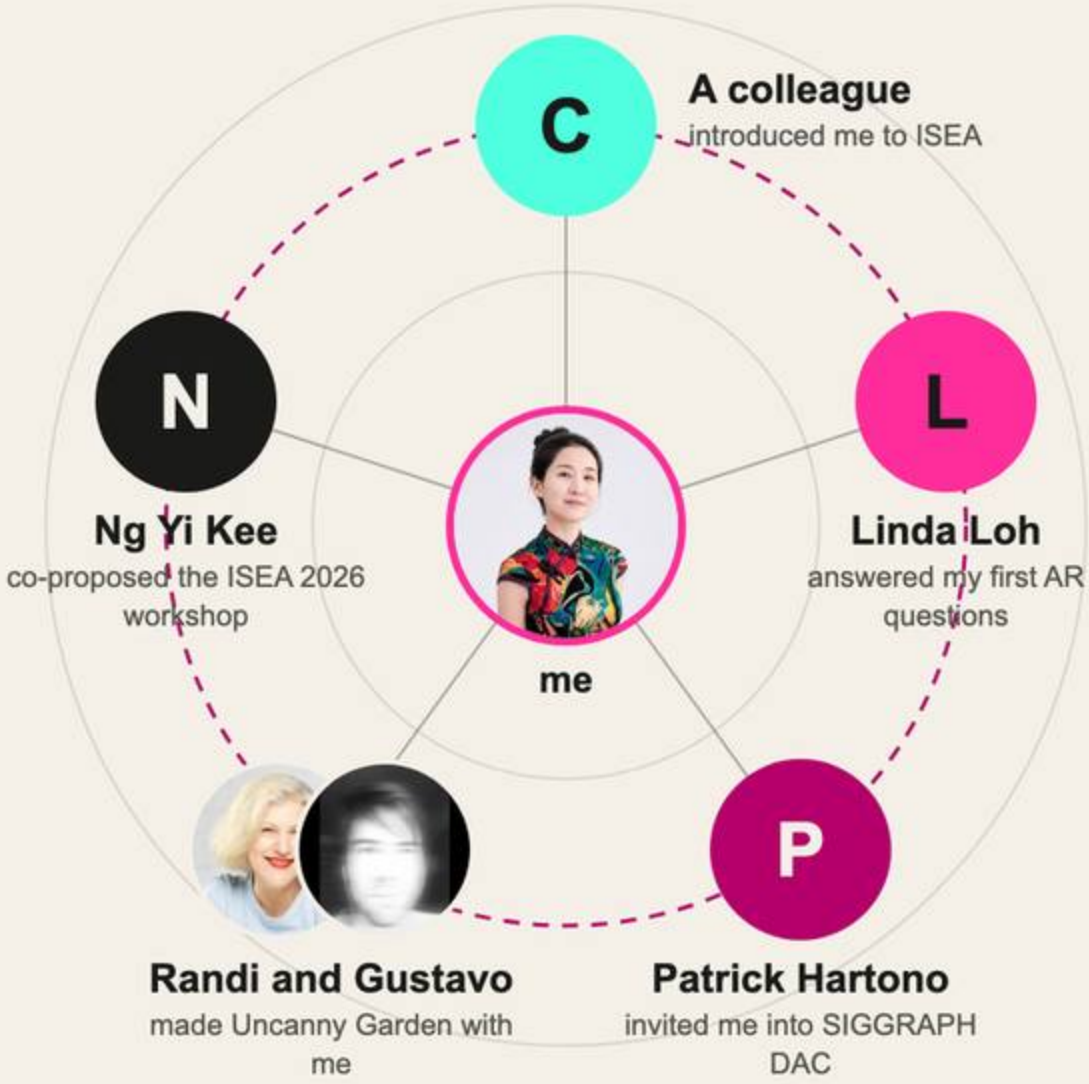
Dec 2026
Next: SIGGRAPH Asia, Kuala Lumpur

About fourteen months from sitting in the audience to exhibiting at SIGGRAPH.

GOING INTERNATIONAL

People opened every door

None of this was solo. Every step came through someone.



GOING INTERNATIONAL · SIGGRAPH

How I got into SIGGRAPH



Bin Youn x Patrick Hartono

01 Tried submitting to DAC Sparks talks

02 Patrick Hartono suggested I join: co-moderator, Jan 2026

03 Kept watching their posts and open calls

04 Applied for an AR collaboration: SIGGRAPH DAC and LACDA, July 2026

ISEA 2026 · DUBAI · MY WORKSHOP PROPOSAL

Counting Cultural Stars

Yoon Dong-ju, 1941: “One star for memory, one for love… one for mother.” Naming stars to keep a suppressed identity alive.

Handwrite your own cultural words, photograph them, and turn them into a 3D constellation.

With Ng Yi Kee (MMU) · re-proposed, awaiting approval



GOING INTERNATIONAL

How to start, the way I did

01

Go

Attend, even as an observer

02

Meet people

Ask questions. Say yes.

03

Set a goal

“Next year, I’ll be part of it.”

04

Build

Tools you can run alone

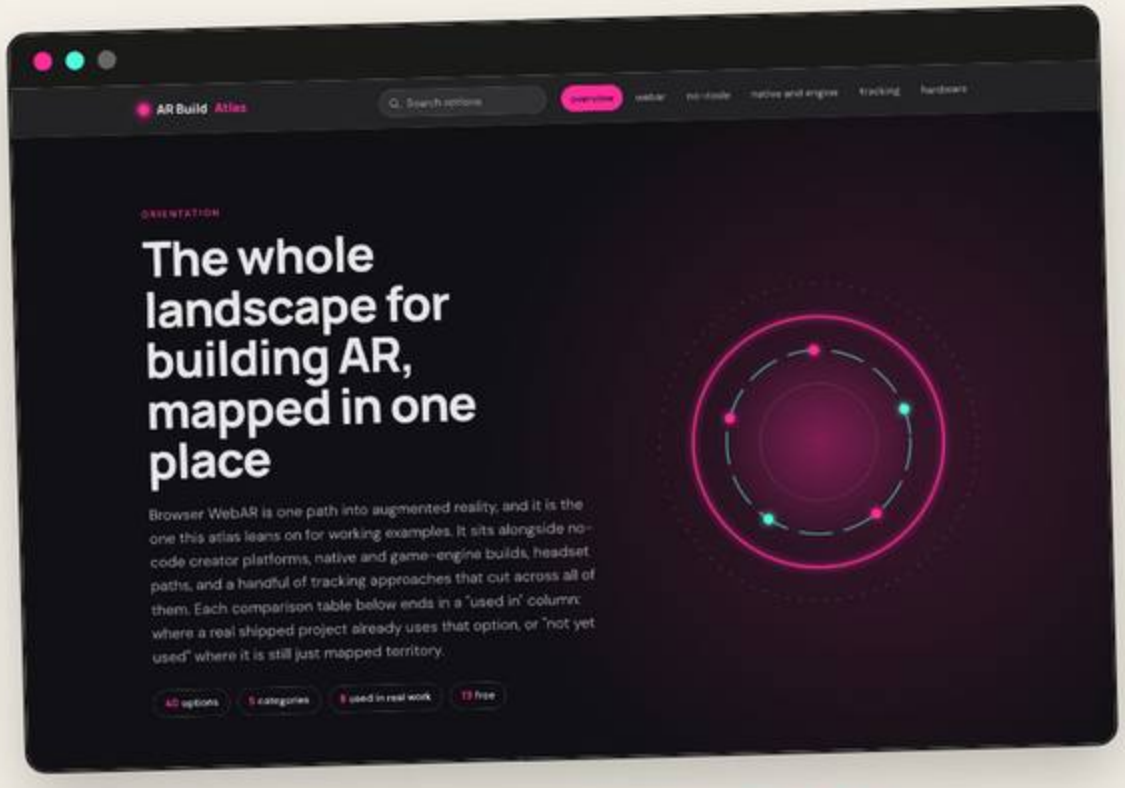
05

Keep applying

Answer the calls. Try again.

FREE TO USE

Start where I wish I had



AR Build Atlas · every way to build AR, compared

binyoun.github.io/ar-build-atlas



Elemental WebAR · photos that open in AR

binyoun.github.io/webar

GOING INTERNATIONAL · 2026

This year's venues

TODAY

19–23 Jul
SIGGRAPH 2026
Los Angeles

Uncanny Garden was here, with DAC

INSTAGRAM
@acmsiggraph
@siggraph_digitalarts

9–13 Sep
Ars Electronica
Linz, Austria

Festival and Prix Ars Electronica

INSTAGRAM
@arselectronica

6–15 Nov
ISEA 2026
Dubai

My workshop proposal, awaiting approval

INSTAGRAM
@iseainternational

1–4 Dec
SIGGRAPH Asia
Kuala Lumpur

The closest to us: go, even as an observer

INSTAGRAM
@siggraphasia

GOING INTERNATIONAL

A WebAR application kit

A LIVE LINK

Runs in the browser, no app. Jurors can try it in seconds: uncanny.live

A DOCUMENTATION VIDEO

Real people using the work in a real space

CODE AND A DOI

Open source on GitHub; a citable record on figshare

WORDS

A short statement, a bio, and what the work needs to run

GOING INTERNATIONAL

Build your portfolio as you go

Keep track

Post every step on Instagram: sketches, tests, shows. Your feed becomes your record.

Follow the journey: @o.binyoun.o

Keep networking

Talk to artists, ask questions, follow up. That's how my collaborations started.

Go and experience

Shows, festivals, conferences. I started at ISEA as an observer.

PART 04 · 15–20 MIN

Student projects

M-NODE Cross-Cultural Hackathon · DIMA (Korea) × RMIT Vietnam · 18–23 January 2026



STUDENT PROJECTS · M-NODE BRIEF

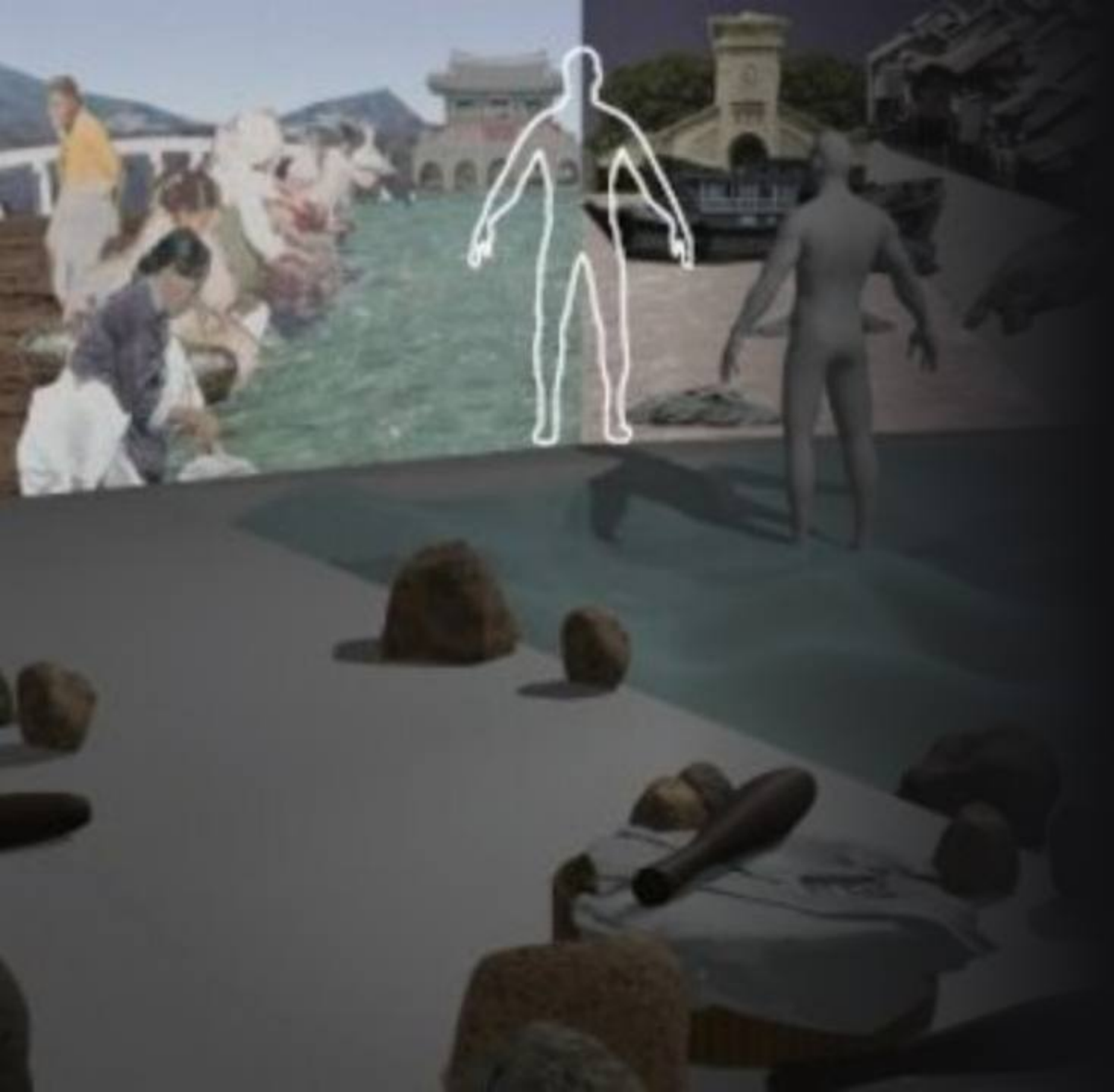
Lost Places, Living Stories

6
mixed Korean–Vietnamese teams

5 2
days

cities, one archive

THE ONE RULE No software until you've gone to the place.



TEAM E

Memories of Water

Suwon’s riverside laundries meet the Hàm Nghi canal. Step into the water and your body moves the memories.

599 / 800 · top planning score

TEAM M

Still Current

A Vietnamese floating house and a Korean shanty house: two impermanent homes. Walk through them with your hands.

526 / 800 · Blender + Unity, hand tracking



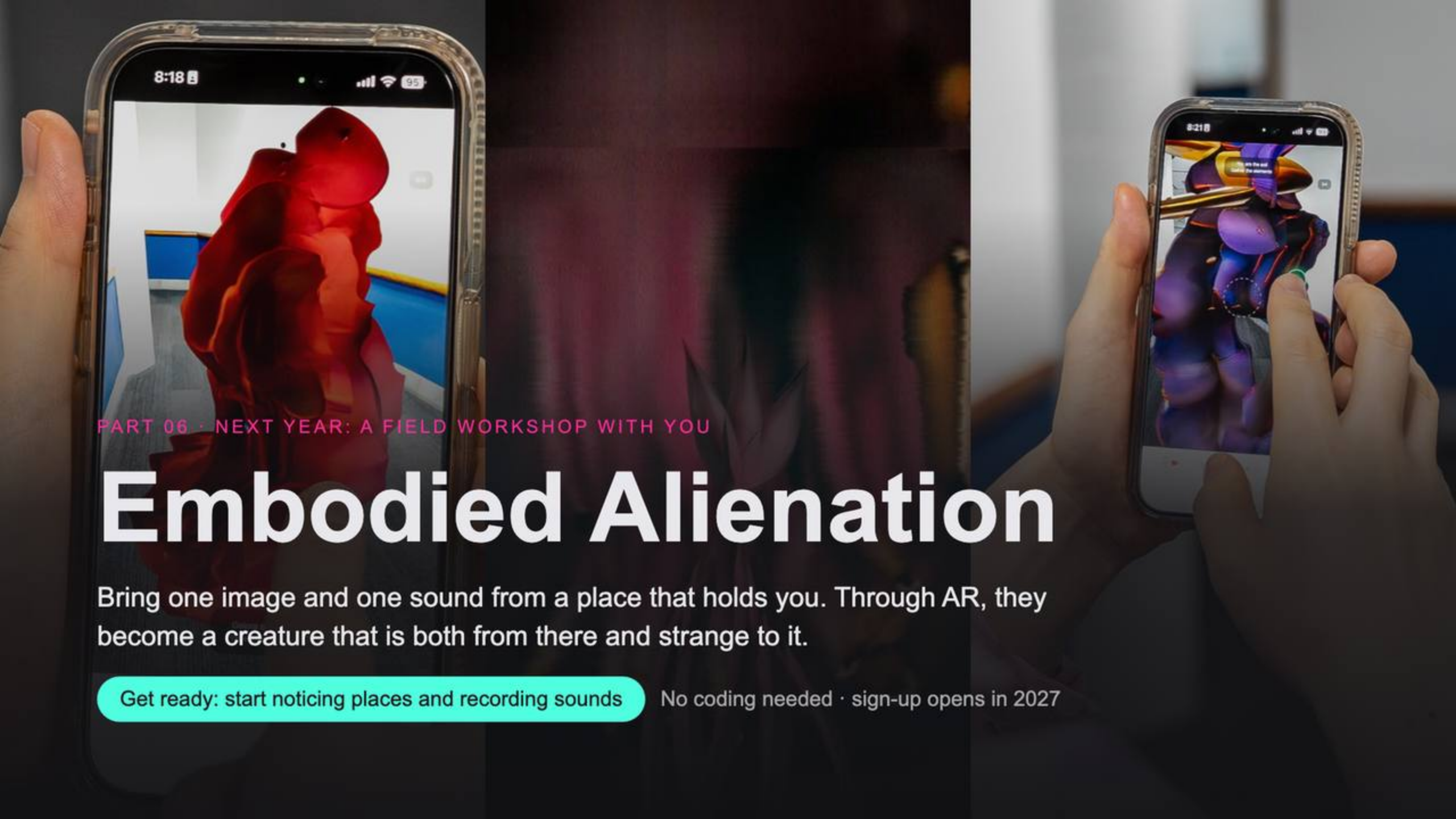
WHAT THE PROJECTS TAUGHT US

Go to the place and the people before you open the software.

The teams with the strongest field evidence made the strongest work.

PART 05 · QUESTIONS & DISCUSSION

What would you like to make in AR?



PART 06 · NEXT YEAR: A FIELD WORKSHOP WITH YOU

Embodied Alienation

Bring one image and one sound from a place that holds you. Through AR, they become a creature that is both from there and strange to it.

Get ready: start noticing places and recording sounds

No coding needed · sign-up opens in 2027

BEFORE YOU GO · FINISH THE SENTENCE

Next year, I'll be part of _____.

An exhibition, a festival, a conference, a collaboration. Name one.



Thank you

Bin Youn

binyoun.com · @o.binyoun.o · sierra.biny@icloud.com

Try the work: gelora-xr.xyz · uncanny.live